

Parent/Guardian Student Data Breach Notification

Plain-language sample notification for a reportable incident involving student information

OWNER
Cybersecurity Coordinator
+ Communications + Legal

DISTRICT
Ardent ISD

REVIEW CYCLE
Annual + after major incident

POLICY CROSS-REFERENCE

CQB FL

Incident Response Plan

Training Sample - Customize Before Use. This document is an instructional artifact for Ardent ISD. It should be aligned to current board policy, administrative procedures, cyber-insurance requirements, records-retention requirements, and advice of district legal counsel before operational use. Legal and reporting requirements can change.

Sample Notice - AISD-IR-2026-004

Date: March 12, 2026
To: Parent/Guardian of an Ardent ISD Student
Subject: Notice of Cybersecurity Incident Involving Student Information

Dear Parent or Guardian,

Ardent ISD is writing to inform you about a cybersecurity incident involving a third-party student support platform used by the district. We take the privacy and security of student information seriously, and we want to explain what occurred, what information may have been involved, and what we are doing in response.

What happened

On March 3, 2026, the district was notified that an unauthorized person had used a vendor support account to access the Student Success Portal. The vendor disabled the account, and Ardent ISD began an investigation with cybersecurity and legal support. The investigation identified unauthorized access activity between February 27 and March 2, 2026.

What information was involved

Based on the information available as of the date of this letter, the affected portal contained the following information for your student:

- student name;
- district student identification number;
- campus and grade level;

- parent/guardian email address; and
- limited program-participation information used to support student services.

The affected portal **did not contain Social Security numbers, financial account information, district passwords, or student health records.**

What Ardent ISD has done

Ardent ISD has:

- disabled the affected vendor access path and reviewed related credentials;
- preserved relevant logs and records for investigation;
- reported the incident through applicable Texas cybersecurity reporting channels;
- required the vendor to provide additional security information and corrective actions;
- increased monitoring of the affected service; and
- begun a review of vendor access controls and support-account practices across other district systems.

What you need to do

At this time, we are not asking you or your student to change a district password because district credentials were not stored in the affected portal. As a general precaution, be alert for messages that use school-related information to create a false sense of urgency. Ardent ISD will never ask a student or parent to send a password through email or text message.

If our investigation identifies additional information that changes the steps you should take, we will contact you.

Questions

A current incident FAQ is available through the Ardent ISD family communications page. Families may also contact the district's designated incident support line during published business hours.

We regret the concern this incident may cause. Ardent ISD will continue to provide updates when there is meaningful new information to share.

Sincerely,

Morgan Lee

Chief Technology Officer / Cybersecurity Coordinator
Ardent Independent School District

Customization Checklist Before Sending

- ☐ Legal counsel confirms the notice is required and approves wording.
- ☐ Facts match forensic findings and vendor documentation.
- ☐ Information categories are specific; avoid vague phrases such as “some data.”
- ☐ Do not claim data was “not accessed” unless evidence supports that statement.

- ☐ State whether credentials, SSNs, financial data, health data, special education data, or other high-risk data were involved when known.
- ☐ Include identity/credit monitoring only when appropriate to the data and incident.
- ☐ Provide accessible, multilingual versions appropriate for district families.
- ☐ Coordinate website FAQ, call center, campus leader scripts, and media holding statement.
- ☐ Preserve the final notice, distribution list/method, and date sent in the incident record.

Why This Sample Is Written This Way

The sample separates verified facts from ongoing investigation, explains the specific data categories, states what was *not* present only where the sample facts support it, and gives families a practical action. Texas Education Code §11.175 includes a parent-notice duty for reportable incidents involving student information. The U.S. Department of Education's breach-response guidance recommends adapting notices to the incident and consulting legal counsel.

References

- Texas Education Code § 11.175 - School Cybersecurity
- U.S. Department of Education - Data Breach Response Checklist
- U.S. Department of Education - Data Security: K-12 and Higher Education
- TASB - School Cybersecurity: Security Breach Notification and Response